India as an example and noted that holding UN membership removed a country from the immoral list since it showed an acceptance of the idea of collective security.[29]

The new tolerance was aided by the fact that the administration no longer believed that it could or should bring India into an alliance.[30] Budget-conscious Eisenhower repeatedly emphasized that it was better for the US that India remain nonaligned. If India sought an alliance with the US, it would require the American taxpayer to take on a greater burden and the US military to help defend "2,000 miles more of active frontier" (alluding to India's China boundary).[31] This attitude was indeed echoed by some on the Hill, such as Representative Albert P. Morano (R-CT), who stated that too much cooperation with India might not be advisable because it could prove costly.[32] Thus the goal was not necessarily to win India over —or require it to come over—to the US side any more, but to ensure that it was not lost to the other side.[33]

Moreover, the age and attraction of alliances in the US had faded somewhat. For the White House, dealing with allies sometimes seemed as, if not more, difficult than dealing with adversaries. Interactions with South Korean leader Syngman Rhee during the Korean War, Jiang during the Taiwan Strait crisis, and Britain, France, and Israel during the Suez crisis had contributed to Eisenhower's exacerbation with allies. By fall 1956, Eisenhower had directed committees to assess US alliances and propose ways of reducing military aid packages to certain allies. More specifically, in India's neighborhood, the president and a number of American officials had come to see the alliance with Pakistan as a "burden and a blunder." Eisenhower would note frankly in early 1957, "Our tendency to rush out and seek allies was not very sensible." Finally, there was recognition that some allies were not as important as some neutrals—as Dulles made evident when he contended that he "would rather see us lose Thailand, an ally, than to lose India, a neutral."[34]

Indian policymakers were neither unaware nor unappreciative of the changes in Washington. Nehru detected a "variety of opinion" on nonalignment, approvingly noting that Eisenhower had "put in a good word" for it.[35] He felt that there was less rigidity in the US and "more understanding" that India's nonalignment was not just a matter of principle, but, more important, of practicality.[36] For India, the benefits of staying